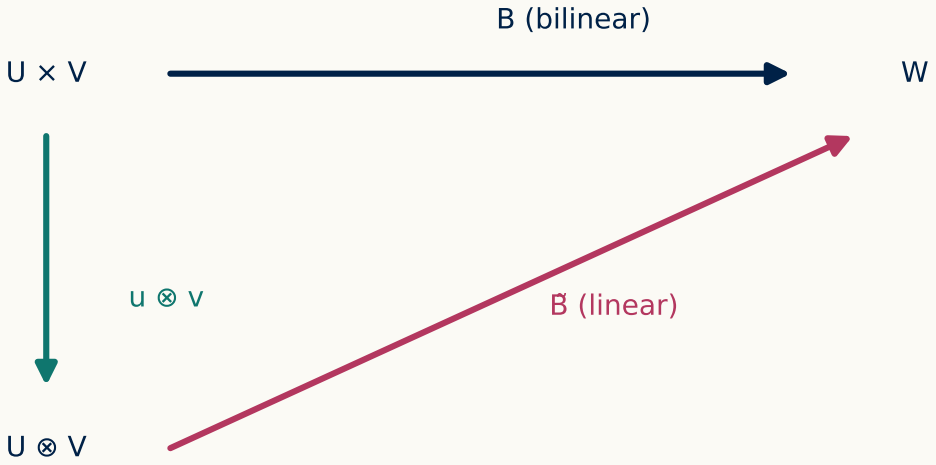A bilinear rule factors through the tensor product